

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

2005-12-27

To the Conference of the Continental Boards of Cou

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27 December 2005

To the Conference of the Continental Boards of Counsellors

Dearly loved Friends,

^{1.1} Over the past four and a half years, as the believers
throughout the world have striven to pursue the aim of advancing the process of entry by troops, it has become increasingly clear that the close of the present Five Year Plan will mark a decisive moment in the unfoldment of the historical enterprise

² on which the community of the Greatest Name is embarked. The elements required for a concerted effort to infuse the

diverse regions of the world with the spirit of Bahá'u'lláh's

³ Revelation have crystallized into a framework for action that now needs only to be exploited.

^{1.2} Our 26 December 1995 message, which focused the Bahá'í
world on a path of intense learning about the sustained, rapid growth of the Faith, described in general terms the nature of the work that would have to be undertaken in meeting the challenges ahead. As a first step, Bahá'í communities were urged

2 to systematize their efforts to develop the human resources of the Cause through a
network of training institutes. While

every national community took measures to create institu-

3 tional capacity to perform this essential function, it was not until the outset of the
Five Year Plan that the significance of a

4 well-conceived program of training became widely appreciated.

The introduction of the concept of the cluster made it possible

for the friends to think about the accelerated growth of the

5 community on a manageable scale and to conceive of it in terms of two
complementary, reinforcing movements: the steady flow

of individuals through the sequence of institute courses and

6 the movement of clusters from one stage of development to the next. This image
helped the believers to analyze the lessons

being learned in the field and to employ a common vocabulary

to articulate their findings. Never before have the means for

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8 FRAMEWORK FOR ACTIONEstablishing a pattern of activity that places equal
emphasis on

the twin processes of expansion and consolidation been better

understood. Indeed, so consistent has been the experience with

intensive programs of growth, implemented on the basis of this

understanding in divers clusters, that no cause for equivocation

remains. The way forward is clear, and at Rid .ván 2006 we will

call upon the believers to steel their resolve and to proceed with

the full force of their energies on the course that has been so

9 decidedly set.

1.3 In presenting to you the features of the coming Five Year

Plan, the subject of your deliberations in this conference, we

will review the record of recent accomplishments of the Bahá'í

world and indicate how current approaches, methods and

instruments should be carried to this next stage. What the analysis will make evident is that the wholehearted response of the individual believer, the community and the institutions to the guidance they received five years ago has raised their capacity to new levels. The continued development of this capacity will remain essential to the aim of advancing the process of entry by troops—the focus of the Bahá'í world through the final 2 years of the first century of the Formative Age.

The Individual

1.4 There is little need to describe in detail the achievements of the individual believer, for we have already noted these in 2 our message of 17 January 2003 to the Bahá'ís of the world.

In that message we highlighted the growing sense of initiative and resourcefulness, as well as the courage and audacity, that

3 have come to characterize believers everywhere. Qualities such as consecration, zeal, confidence and tenacity attest to the

enhanced vitality of their faith. We have also acknowledged

4 the role played by the training institute in evoking the spirit of enterprise underlying the rise in activity observed around the

5 world—the concrete expression of that vitality.

1.5 Developments since then have served only to demonstrate

2 further the efficacy of a sequence of courses that seeks to build capacity for service by concentrating on the application of

the spiritual insights gained through profound study of the

Writings. Participants are exposed to a body of knowledge

3 that fosters a set of related habits, attitudes and qualities and are assisted in sharpening certain skills and abilities needed to

carry out acts of service. Discussions that revolve around the

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study circle, raise the level of consciousness about one's duties

to the Cause and create an awareness of the joy one derives

from teaching the Faith and serving its interests. The spiritual

context in which specific deeds are addressed endows them

5 with significance. Confidence is patiently built as the friends engage in progressively more complex and demanding acts of

service. Yet, above all, it is reliance on God that sustains them

6 in their endeavors. How abundant the accounts of believers who enter the teaching field with trepidation only to find

themselves bolstered by confirmations on all sides. Seeing the

7 possibilities and opportunities before them with new eyes,

they witness firsthand the power of Divine assistance, as they

8 strive to put into practice what they are learning and achieve results far exceeding their expectations. That the spirit of faith

born out of intimate contact with the Word of God has such

9 an effect on souls is by no means a new phenomenon. What is heartening is that the institute process is helping such large

numbers experience the transforming potency of the Faith. To

extend this edifying influence to hundreds of thousands more

10 should be the object of intense effort over the next five years.

1.6 A discernible outcome of the emphasis on capacity building

2 has been a steady increase in the exercise of individual initiative—initiative that is disciplined by an understanding of the

requirements of systematic action in advancing the process of

entry by troops. Endeavors are pursued in a humble posture of

3 learning within the framework defined by the Plan. As a result, activities that give expression to a diversity of talents become

harmonized into one forward movement, and the stagnation

4 caused by endless debate over personal preferences about approach is avoided. Commitment to long-term action grows,

putting in context the initiatives undertaken by the believers at

5 any particular moment.

1.7 Nowhere has the rise in individual initiative been more

clearly demonstrated than in the field of teaching. Whether in the form of firesides or study circles, individual efforts to teach the Faith are indisputably on the increase. Equipped with skills and methods, effective and accessible to all, and encouraged by

2 the response their actions elicit, the believers are entering into closer association with people of many walks of life, engaging

3 them in earnest conversation on themes of spiritual import.

With greater and greater spiritual perception, they are able to

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5 FRAMEWORK FOR ACTIONsense receptivity and recognize thirst for the vivifying waters of

Bahá'u'lláh's message. From among all those they encounter—

parents of neighborhood children, peers at school, colleagues

at work, casual acquaintances—they seek out souls with whom

they can share a portion of that which He has so graciously

6 bestowed on humanity. Increased experience enables them to adapt their presentation to the seeker's needs, employing

direct teaching methods that draw on the Writings to offer the

7 message in a manner both forthcoming and inviting.

1.8 Most noteworthy in this regard is the spirit of initiative

shown by believers who extend the range of their endeavors

to assist others also striving to tread a path of service. Having

2 acquired the capacity to serve as tutors of institute courses,

they take up the challenge of accompanying participants in

3 their initial attempts to perform acts of service until they, too, are ready to start their own study circles and help others do the

same, widening in this way the scope of the institute's influence

4 and bringing eager souls into contact with the Word of God. This particular aspect of the institute process, which serves

to multiply the number of active supporters of the Faith in a

self-perpetuating manner, holds much promise, and we hope

that its potential will be realized in the coming Plan. “Let him

5 not be content,” are the words of the Guardian referring to ev-ery teacher of the Cause, “until he has infused into his spiritual

6 child so deep a longing as to impel him to arise independently,

7 in his turn, and devote his energies to the quickening of other souls, and the upholding of the laws and principles laid down

by his newly adopted Faith.”

The Community

1.9 The enhanced vitality that distinguishes the life of the

2 individual believer is equally evident in Bahá’í community life. The degree to which this vitality manifests itself depends, of

course, on the stage of development of the cluster. A cluster

in an advanced stage of growth offers far greater insight into

3 what can be achieved than one in an earlier stage, where the friends are still struggling to translate the provisions of the Plan

into action. It is to these more advanced clusters, then, that we

4 must look in analyzing the accomplishments of the community, convinced that their experience will be emulated by others as

5 they continue to progress.

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coherence that is brought to the process of growth through

the establishment of study circles, devotional meetings and

7 children’s classes. The steady multiplication of core activities,

propelled by the training institute, creates a sustainable pattern

8 of expansion and consolidation that is at once structured and organic. As seekers join these activities and declare their faith, individual and collective teaching endeavors gather momentum.

Through the effort made to ensure that a percentage of the

new believers enroll in the institute courses, the pool of human

9 resources required to carry out the work of the Faith swells.

10 When strenuously pursued in a cluster, all of this activity eventually brings about
conditions favorable for launching an

11 intensive program of growth.

1.11 What a close examination of clusters at this threshold

2 confirms is that the coherence thus achieved extends to various aspects of community
life. The study and application of the

teachings become a pervasive habit, and the spirit of communal

worship generated by devotional meetings begins to permeate

3 the community's collective endeavors. A graceful integration of the arts into diverse
activities enhances the surge of energy that

mobilizes the believers. Classes for the spiritual education of

4 children and junior youth serve to strengthen the roots of the Faith in the local
population. Even an act of service as simple

as visiting the home of a new believer, whether in a village in

5 the Pacific Islands or in a vast metropolitan area like London,

reinforces ties of fellowship that bind the members of the com-

6 munity together. Conceived as a means for exposing believers to the fundamentals of
the Faith, "home visits" are giving rise

7 to an array of deepening efforts, both individual and collective,

8 in which the friends are delving into the Writings and exploring their implications for
their lives.

1.12 As the spiritual foundations of the community are fortified

in this way, the level of collective discourse is raised, social

relations among the friends take on new meaning, and a sense

2 of common purpose inspires their interactions. Little wonder,

then, that a study carried out by the International Teaching

3 Centre shows that, in some fifty advanced clusters surveyed, the quality of the
Nineteen Day Feast has improved. Other reports

indicate that contributions to the Fund have increased as con-

4 sciousness of its spiritual significance expands and the need for material means is
better understood. Reflection meetings at the

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6 FRAMEWORK FOR ACTION cluster level are becoming a forum for the discussion of needs

and plans, creating a collective identity and strengthening the

collective will. Where such advanced clusters are flourishing, the

influence they exert begins to spread beyond their own borders

7 to enrich regional events, such as summer and winter schools.

1.13 As in the case of the individual, learning is the hallmark of

this phase of the development of the community. You and your

auxiliaries are urged to exert every effort in the coming years

to ensure that, in cluster after cluster, learning is woven into the

2 fabric of decision making.

1.14 One of your primary concerns will be to strengthen appreci-

ation for systematic action, already heightened by the successes

it has brought. To arrive at a unified vision of growth based on

a realistic assessment of possibilities and resources, to develop

strategies that lend structure to it, to devise and implement

2 plans of action commensurate with capacity, to make necessary adjustments while maintaining continuity, to build on accom-

plishments—these are some of the requisites of systematization

3 that every community must learn and internalize.

1.15 By the same token, desire and willingness to open certain as-

pects of community life to the wider public should be integrated

2 into a pattern of behavior that attracts souls and confirms them.

Much has been achieved in this respect as the friends have

3 adopted new ways of thinking and acting at a collective level.

4 In welcoming large numbers into its embrace, the community is learning to see more readily the latent potentiality in people

and to avoid setting artificial barriers for them based on pre-

5 conceived notions. A nurturing environment is being cultivated in which each individual is encouraged to progress at his or her

6 own pace without the pressure of unreasonable expectations.

At the heart of such developments is a growing awareness of

the implications of the universality and comprehensiveness of

7 the Faith. Collective action is governed more and more by the principle that Bahá'u'lláh's message should be given liberally

and unconditionally to humanity. Most gratifying are the

8 endeavors being made to reach receptive populations with the teachings of the Faith. As unrelenting social and political forces

continue to uproot people from their homelands and sweep

them across continents, an uncompromising appreciation for a

diversity of backgrounds and for the strength it confers on the

9 whole will prove crucial to the expansion and consolidation of the community.

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your auxiliaries above all others is to assist the community in its

effort to maintain focus. This ability, slowly acquired through

11 successive Plans, represents one of its most valuable assets,

hard won through discipline, commitment and foresight as the

12 friends and their institutions have learned to pursue the single aim of advancing the process of entry by troops. On the one hand, you will find it necessary to discourage the tendency to

confuse focus with uniformity or exclusivity. To maintain focus

13 does not imply that special needs and interests are neglected,

much less that essential activities are dropped in order to

14 accommodate others. Clearly, there are a host of elements that comprise Bahá'í community life, shaped over the decades,

which must be further refined and developed. On the other

15 hand, you will want to take every opportunity to reinforce the disposition to prioritize—one which recognizes that not all

16 activities have the same importance at a given stage of growth,

that some must necessarily take precedence over others, that

17 even the most well-intentioned proposals can cause distraction,

18 dissipate energy or impede progress. What should be plainly acknowledged is that
the time available for the friends to serve

the Faith in every community is not without limits. It is only

19 natural to expect that the preponderating share of this limited resource would be
expended in meeting the provisions of the

20 Plan.

The Institutions

1.17 None of the accomplishments of the individual or the
community could be sustained without the guidance, encour -
agement and support of the third participant in the Plan—the
institutions of the Faith. It is heartening to see to what extent

the institutions are promoting individual initiative, channeling

2 energies into the teaching field, underscoring the value of sys-tematic action,
fostering the spiritual life of the community and

nurturing a welcoming environment. In helping the community

3 to remain focused on the aim of the Plan, they are learning in practical terms what it
means to maintain unity of vision

among the friends, to put mechanisms in place that facilitate

their endeavors and to allocate resources in accordance with

priorities wisely set. These priorities include, of course, areas of

4 activity that require the specialized skills of individuals. Worthy of particular
mention in this category are the work of external

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6 FRAMEWORK FOR ACTIONaffairs, which National Spiritual Assemblies are
following

7 diligently, and ventures of social and economic development,

8 as, for example, undertaken by Bahá'í-inspired organizations.

While tending to needs of this kind, the institutions find

themselves increasingly capable of directing the thrust of the

9 effort exerted by the generality of the believers towards the prosecution of the central
tasks of the Plan.

1.18 Encouraging, too, are the determined steps being taken

by National Spiritual Assemblies, in collaboration with the

Counsellors, to respond to the administrative challenges

brought by large-scale growth at the cluster level. Schemes that

are emerging tend to call for one or more individuals named

2 by the training institute to coordinate the delivery of courses in the main sequence, as well as programs for children and

junior youth. An Area Teaching Committee appointed by the

3 Regional Council, or by the National Assembly itself, is also required to administer other aspects of systematic effort to

achieve accelerated expansion and consolidation. Auxiliary

Board members work on both fronts to ensure that the two

movements which have come to characterize the process of

4 growth proceed unhampered. While these various components are being established in cluster after cluster, there is still much

to be learned about the functions each is to perform and about

5 the relationships among them. What is important is that the current degree of flexibility, which allows for the creation of

new instruments as needed, not be compromised so that the

scheme of coordination represents a response to the demands

of growth itself. We count on you and National Assemblies to

6 guide this learning process.

1.19 Throughout the Plan, we have watched with the keenest

interest the effects of these developments on the functioning of

Local Spiritual Assemblies. It gives us pleasure to note that two

types of progress are being made in this respect. In those clusters

2 where most of the Local Assemblies have been extremely weak,

3 a growing number are gradually assuming their responsibilities as they learn to guide specific activities of the Plan in the areas

under their jurisdiction. At the same time, long-standing Local

4 Spiritual Assemblies are exhibiting signs of added strength as they have come to embrace a vision of systematic growth—this,

often following a period of adjustment in which some struggled

5 to understand the new realities being created at the cluster level.

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of growth unfolding around the world is gathering momentum

in urban centers as well as rural areas. An important step

taken in many large cities early in the current Plan was to

divide them into sectors. This proved crucial to planning for

7 sustained growth. As communities expand, however, it is not unreasonable to expect that cities will need to be divided into smaller areas—perhaps ultimately into neighborhoods—in each

of which the Nineteen Day Feast is conducted. Maintaining a

vision of the potential size of future communities is essential

for the further development of Local Assemblies. To administer

8 the affairs of communities whose membership will swell into the thousands, and to fulfill their purpose as the “trusted ones

of the Merciful among men,” those who serve on Spiritual

9 Assemblies will necessarily undergo intense periods of learning in the years ahead. We intend to monitor the development of

10 Local Spiritual Assemblies closely during the coming Plan and,

as the size of the Bahá’í population and other circumstances in

a locality demand, authorize a two-stage electoral process on

a case-by-case basis, following the pattern developed in T .ihrán

11 during the ministry of the Guardian.

Intensive Programs of Growth

1.21 Sustained endeavor on the part of the individual, the com-

munity and the institutions to accelerate the institute process in

a cluster, while contributing to its movement from one stage of

development to another through well-proven means, culminates

2 in the launching of an intensive program of growth. Indeed,

3 the most significant advances in learning during the present Plan resulted from
efforts in some two hundred clusters to

implement such programs. We are convinced that this learning

4 can now be systematically propagated in every continent, and at Rid.ván 2006 we will
call upon Bahá'ís worldwide to establish,

5 during the next Plan, intensive programs of growth in no less than 1,500 clusters.

1.22 As currently conceived, an intensive program of growth

is straightforward, simple and effective, but implies a level of

exertion that tests the resolve of the friends. Conforming well

to the vision we presented five years ago, it employs a few

measures that have proven to be indispensable to large-scale

2 expansion and consolidation. It consists of cycles of activity, in general of three
months' duration each, which proceed accord-

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4 **FRAMEWORK FOR ACTION**ing to distinct phases of expansion, consolidation,
reflection

5 and planning.

1.23 The expansion phase, often a period of two weeks, demands

the highest level of intensity. Its objective is to widen the circle

of those interested in the Faith, to find receptive souls and to

2 teach them. Although this phase might include some element of proclamation, it
should not be seen as a time to hold a few

events for this purpose or to undertake a set of activities that

3 merely convey information. Experience suggests that the more closely teaching
approaches and methods are aligned with the

capacity acquired from the study of the institute courses the

4 more rewarding the results.

1.24 Plans being devised for this phase invariably involve the

implementation of carefully designed teaching projects and

campaigns of home visits and firesides, often through the

mobilization of teaching teams. The pattern of expansion that

unfolds, however, varies from cluster to cluster. Where the

2 population has traditionally shown a high degree of receptivity to the Faith, a rapid influx of new believers is to be expected. In

one cluster of this kind, for example, the goal of enrolling fifty

3 souls over a three-week period in a locality was surpassed by the second day, and the team wisely decided to end the expan-

4 sion phase in anticipation of activities related to consolidation.

One of the primary objectives of this next phase is to bring a

percentage of the new believers into the institute process so that

5 an adequate pool of human resources will be available in future cycles to sustain growth. Those not participating in study circles

are nurtured through a series of home visits, and all are invited

6 to devotional meetings, to the celebration of the Nineteen Day Feast and to Holy Day observances and are gradually

7 introduced to the patterns of community life. Not infrequently,

the consolidation phase gives rise to further enrollments as the

8 family members and friends of new declarants accept the Faith.

1.25 In other clusters, enrollments during the expansion phase

2 may not be high, especially in the first few cycles, and the goal is to augment the number of those willing to participate in core

activities. This, then, defines the nature of the consolidation

phase, which largely involves nurturing the interest of seekers

3 and accompanying them in their spiritual search until they are confirmed in their faith. To the extent that these measures are

vigorously followed, this phase can generate a considerable

number of enrollments. It should be noted, however, that as

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to teach responsive souls, but also to identify segments of the

general population with heightened receptivity, develops, and

5 the totality of new believers increases from cycle to cycle.

1.26 Whatever the nature of the cluster, it is imperative to

2 pay close attention to children and junior youth everywhere. Concern for the moral
and spiritual education of young people

3 is asserting itself forcefully on the consciousness of humanity,

4 and no attempt at community building can afford to ignore it.

What has become especially apparent during the current Five

5 Year Plan is the efficacy of educational programs aimed at the spiritual
empowerment of junior youth. When accompanied for

three years through a program that enhances their spiritual per -

6 ception, and encouraged to enter the main sequence of institute courses at the age of
fifteen, they represent a vast reservoir of

7 energy and talent that can be devoted to the advancement of spiritual and material
civilization. So impressed are we by the

results already achieved, and so compelling is the need, that we

8 will urge all National Assemblies to consider the junior youth groups formed
through programs implemented by their training

institutes a fourth core activity in its own right and to promote

9 its wide-scale multiplication.

1.27 Key to the progress of an intensive program of growth is

the phase dedicated to reflection, in which the lessons learned

in action are articulated and incorporated into plans for the

next cycle of activity. Its principal feature is the reflection

meeting—as much a time of joyous celebration as it is of

2 serious consultation. Careful analysis of experience, through participatory
discussions rather than overly complex and

3 elaborate presentations, serves to maintain unity of vision,

4 sharpen clarity of thought and heighten enthusiasm. Central to such an analysis is the
review of vital statistics that suggest the

next set of goals to be adopted. Plans are made that take into

account increased capacity in terms of the human resources

available at the end of the cycle to perform various tasks, on

5 the one hand, and accumulated knowledge about the receptivity of the population
and the dynamics of teaching, on the other.

When human resources increase in a manner proportionate to

6 the rise in the overall Bahá'í population from cycle to cycle, it is possible not only to sustain but to accelerate growth.

1.28 To meet the ambitious goal of establishing 1,500 such

intensive programs, the Bahá'í world will have to draw fully

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3 FRAMEWORK FOR ACTION Upon the experience gained and capacity built over the past

ten years. Following your departure from the Holy Land, you

will need to enter into thorough consultation with National

Spiritual Assemblies and Regional Councils and together care-

fully assess conditions in each national community in order to

4 identify the clusters that will receive focused attention and to map out strategic plans.

1.29 Implementation of these plans should begin as soon as poss-

ible after Rid .ván 2006. Experience in advancing the movement

2 of clusters from one stage to the next is now so widespread that the methods and instruments are well understood. The

institute process must be strengthened so that a sizable number

3 of friends proceed through the main sequence of courses. Intensive institute campaigns that pay adequate attention to the

practice component will be essential in this respect. The number

4 of core activities should be steadily multiplied, and outreach to the wider community systematically extended. Meetings of

reflection will have to be held periodically in order to monitor

progress, maintain unity of thought and mobilize the energies of

the friends. And schemes for administering the growth process

5 should gradually be put in place, as circumstances demand. While capacity at the level of the cluster to sustain growth will

remain the most compelling concern in the coming years, the

6 ongoing development of regional and national structures to facilitate the flow of information and resources to and from the

7 field of action cannot be neglected.

1.30 Equally important will be the support lent to a cluster

2 through an influx of pioneers. The desire to pioneer arises naturally from deep within the heart of the individual believer as

a response to the Divine summons. Whosoever forsakes his or

her home for the purpose of teaching the Cause joins the ranks

3 of those noble souls whose achievements down the decades have illumined the annals of Bahá'í pioneering. We cherish the

hope that many will be moved to render this meritorious service

4 during the next Plan, whether on the home front or in the international field—an act that, in itself, attracts untold blessings.

The institutions, in turn, will have to exercise sound judgment

to ensure that such friends are strategically placed. Priority

should be given to settling short-term and long-term pioneers in

5 those clusters that are the focus of systematic attention, whether as a means of reinforcing endeavors to lay the groundwork for

6 accelerated growth or stabilizing cycles of activity under way.

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on strength will result in the eventual outflow of pioneers from

such clusters to areas destined to become the theatre of future

8 conquests.

1.31 Dear Friends: In the weeks and months ahead and over the

2 course of the Plan, you and your auxiliaries will be a constant source of encouragement to the believers as they rise to the

challenge being presented to them. We ask that you take every

opportunity to convey to them our confidence in their capacity

to overcome the obstacles that will inevitably appear in their

3 path. They should not fail to recognize the scope of what they have achieved through the sustaining grace of Bahá'u'lláh over

the past decade. In the course of the first four years, they cre-

ated the institutional capacity throughout the planet to impart

spiritual education to growing contingents of believers. Building

4 on this accomplishment, they engaged in a rigorous process of learning that opened
before their eyes vistas of great yet

attainable possibilities. That the Bahá'í world has succeeded in

5 multiplying the number of devotional meetings sixfold over the past five years, that
classes for children and junior youth have

increased more than threefold during the same period, that the

number of study circles worldwide has surpassed eleven thou-

sand—these provide a measure of the extraordinary strength

6 the believers can draw upon in shouldering the responsibility entrusted to them.

1.32 Above all, the friends need to remain ever conscious of the

2 magnitude of the spiritual forces that are at their disposition.

3 They are members of a community “whose world-embracing,

continually consolidating activities constitute the one integrat-

ing process in a world whose institutions, secular as well as

4 religious, are for the most part dissolving.” Of all the peoples of the world, “they
alone can recognize, amidst the welter of a

tempestuous age, the Hand of the Divine Redeemer that traces

5 its course and controls its destinies. They alone are aware of the silent growth of that
orderly world polity whose fabric

they themselves are weaving.” It is their institutions that “will

come to be regarded as the hallmark and glory of the age” they

have been called upon to establish. The “building process,”

6 to which they are consecrated, is “the one hope of a stricken society.” For, it is
“actuated by the generating influence of God’s

changeless Purpose, and is evolving within the framework

of the Administrative Order of His Faith.” And remind them

7 16

8 FRAMEWORK FOR ACTIONthat they are the illumined souls envisioned by
‘Abdu’l-Bahá in

His prayer: “Heroes are they, O my Lord, lead them to the field

of battle. Guides are they, make them to speak out with argu-

ments and proofs. Ministering servants are they, cause them to

pass round the cup that brimmeth with the wine of certitude. O

⁹ my God, make them to be songsters that carol in fair gardens, make them lions that couch in the thickets, whales that plunge

in the vasty deep.”

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]